LONG-RANGE PLAN · FY27–FY29

Acme Corp — Long-Range Strategic Plan, FY27–FY29

A three-year plan to grow to ~$1B and lift EBITDA margin to 16%

Document type Board-level strategic plan
Period FY27–FY29
Owner Gregory Whitfield, CEO; Corporate Strategy & Finance
Prepared July 2026

Starting point (FY25)	**$812M net revenue, +5.1% · EBITDA 14.2%**
Net-revenue target	**~$880M FY27 → ~$950M FY28 → ~$1.02B FY29**
Implied CAGR (target)	**~7–8% off FY25 base**
EBITDA-margin target	**14.2% → 16.0% by FY28**
Where we win	**Wellness Protein · oat milk · RGM · eCommerce**
Where we're exposed	**GLP-1 volume, private label, Larksfield in the South**

Executive summary

Acme enters the plan period as the #4 US ready-to-eat cereal maker with a $812M, +5.1% FY25 and a franchise that is stable nationally but under pressure in two specific places — Crunchwell's relevance and its Louisiana share. The three-year job is not a turnaround; it is a mix shift. We grow the company to roughly $1.02B by FY29 by leaning into the two fastest pockets we already play in (Wellness Protein and oat milk), fixing Crunchwell's relevance rather than its trust, and converting commercial rigour — revenue growth management and retail-media discipline — into margin. Every revenue and margin figure past FY26 in this document is a ***planning target****, not a forecast of measured results.*

- **The commitment:** net revenue to ~$880M (FY27), ~$950M (FY28) and ~$1.02B (FY29) — a ~7–8% CAGR off the $812M FY25 base — with EBITDA margin lifting from 14.2% to 16.0% by FY28.
- **Five growth pillars** carry the plan: win Wellness Protein (ProteinPeak $48M→~$140M by FY29, target), fix Crunchwell relevance (68.6→62.7 and falling), ride oat milk with RootDay (+18.8% category), monetise the portfolio through revenue growth management, and scale eCommerce and retail media.
- **Portfolio roles are explicit:** grow ProteinPeak and RootDay, maintain TrailGrove and MorningOats, fix Crunchwell, and prune the HoneyNest tail in a structurally declining Kids-Sweet segment (–2.8%).
- **The risks are named and sized:** the GLP-1 appetite shift (0.81 strength, volume-down), private-label pressure, and Larksfield's escalation of the protein and Louisiana fronts. The plan funds against each rather than assuming them away.

1 · Where we are

FY25 NET REVENUE	EBITDA MARGIN	US RTE SHARE	Q1 FY26 VS PLAN	FASTEST POCKET
$812M	**14.2%**	**5.7%**	**-5.3%**	**+18.3%**
+5.1% YoY	target 16% by FY28	#4 nationally	trajectory improving	Wellness Protein

FY25 closed at $812M net revenue, up 5.1%, at a 14.2% EBITDA margin — a healthy base, but one built on a portfolio whose centre of gravity (Crunchwell, Family Sweet) grows at category rate (~1.4%) while the pockets we most want to own grow at ten times that. The near-term reads amber: Q1 FY26 landed -5.3% behind plan ($181.1M vs $191.2M), concentrated in Crunchwell's Louisiana erosion and a deliberate ProteinPeak pre-launch draw-down. Neither is a national franchise problem, and both are actively managed (see the Q1 Company Business Review, Report 11). The strategic question this plan answers is not "how do we stop the bleeding" — it is "where do we put the next three years of investment so the company compounds."

> **The one-line diagnosis**
> Acme is a trusted, slow-growth portfolio sitting next to two fast-growth pockets it already competes in. The plan is a deliberate mix shift toward Wellness Protein and oat milk, funded by commercial discipline on the mature core — not a bet on reviving a declining segment.

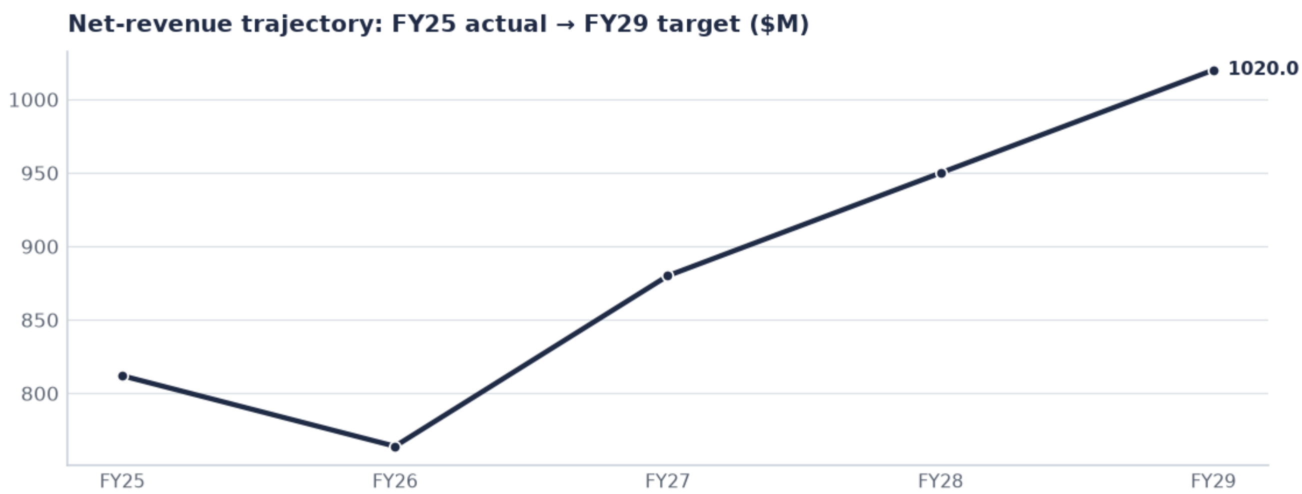
2 · Three-year financial commitments (planning targets)

The financial frame below is the Board-level commitment for the plan period. FY25 and FY26 anchor to actuals and the current-year plan; FY27–FY29 are **planning targets**. The shape is deliberate: revenue growth accelerates as the ProteinPeak build compounds and the Crunchwell turnaround stabilises the core, while margin expands ahead of revenue as revenue growth management and media discipline convert to gross profit.

2.1 · Revenue and margin commitment

Fiscal year	Net revenue	Growth	EBITDA margin	Role in the plan
FY25 (actual)	$812M	+5.1%	14.2%	Base year
FY26 (plan)	~$764M*	run-rate	~14%	Reset year; hold on ProteinPeak launch
FY27 (target)	~$880M	~+8%	~15%	Protein + RGM inflect
FY28 (target)	~$950M	~+8%	16.0%	Margin commitment year
FY29 (target)	~$1.02B	~+7%	16%+	Cross the $1B line

*Source: FY25 net revenue & EBITDA per FACTS.md; FY26 run-rate = $63.7M/mo plan basis (plan_vs_actual). *FY26 shown at annualised plan run-rate; FY27–FY29 are planning targets.*



FY25 actual and FY26 plan run-rate; FY27–FY29 are planning targets, ~7–8% CAGR to ~$1.02B.

What the margin commitment requires

Lifting EBITDA margin ~180 bps to 16% by FY28 is roughly $17M of structural profit on the FY28 revenue base. About half is planned to come from revenue growth management (pricing, mix, trade efficiency — see Report 17) and half from mix shift into higher-margin Wellness Protein and premium oat milk. It is a commitment underwritten by named levers, not by cost-out alone.

3 · The five growth pillars

The plan resolves to five pillars. The first three are where growth comes from; the last two are how we fund and deliver it. Each pillar has an owner, a measurable target, and a linked operating plan.

3.1 · Win Wellness Protein (ProteinPeak)

Wellness Protein is the category's fastest pocket — $710M (FY24) to $840M (FY25), +18.3%, and running +18.6% in the Q2 FY26 read — and it is where Acme is gaining share (7.1% → 7.6% → 8.4%). ProteinPeak is the engine: $48M in FY25 (+24.6%), building to ~$80M in FY26 on the April Cinnamon Crunch / Cocoa Almond launch, and to **~$140M by FY29 (target)** on a rolling innovation cadence and mass-channel expansion beyond the Target stronghold (Acme holds 18.4% Wellness-Protein share at Target vs 5.2% at Walmart). The detailed roadmap sits in the ProteinPeak plan, Report 23.

3.2 · Fix Crunchwell relevance

Crunchwell is trusted but drifting. Top-two-box Relevance has fallen from 68.6 (FY25Q1) to 62.7 (FY26Q2), –5.9 points, while Trust holds (72.3 → 72.9). This is a relevance problem, not a trust problem — the brand is respected but losing cultural pull, most acutely in Louisiana (–340 bps of local share). The fix is the August Pack Refresh ($28M year-one innovation, launch 2026-08-15) plus the funded Louisiana recovery; the full turnaround plan is Report 24.

3.3 · Ride oat milk (RootDay)

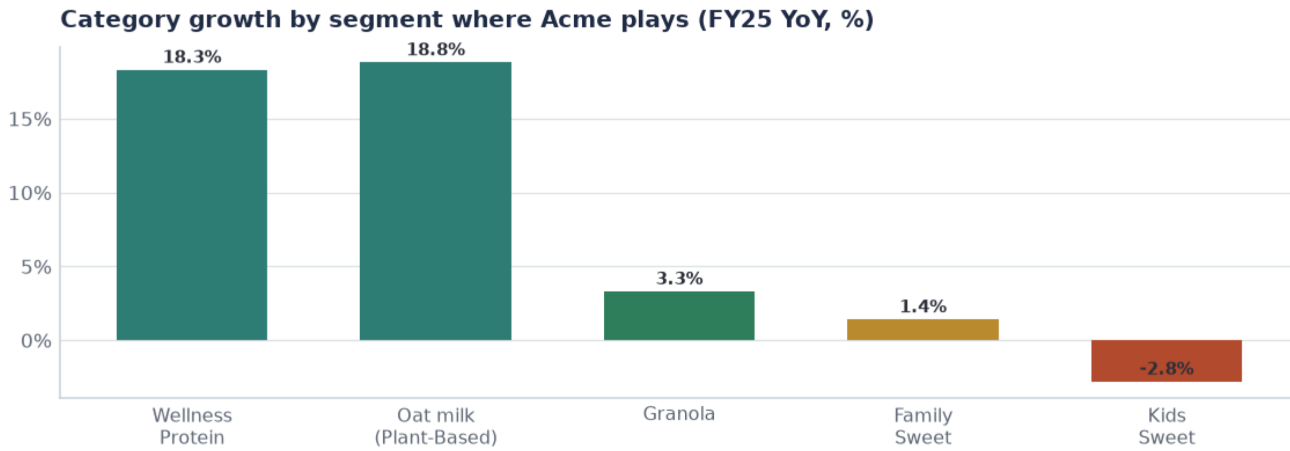
Oat milk (Plant-Based) is a $1.64B, +18.8% category where RootDay is a small but fast-growing player (FY25 ~$62M). The plan protects and extends RootDay's position in a structurally-growing space, with innovation (single-serve, coffee-creamer adjacencies) staged behind the protein build.

3.4 · Revenue growth management & margin

The margin commitment runs through revenue growth management: pricing architecture, promotion efficiency, price-pack architecture, trade terms, and mix. Crunchwell's trade rate (~25.6% of gross, 0.57 incrementality) and the blended $0.65-per-$1 retail-media return are the two largest efficiency prizes. The lever-by-lever plan and the quantified prize are in Report 17.

3.5 · eCommerce & retail media

eCommerce and retail media are the fastest-growing route to shopper. The FY27–FY29 plan scales the channels that pay back — Walmart Connect (1.20 incrementality) and Kroger Precision (0.77) — and structurally de-weights the Amazon-Ads drag (0.40), reinvesting the freed dollars into the pockets and geographies with the highest marginal ROI.



The plan tilts investment toward the two +18% pockets and away from the –2.8% Kids-Sweet tail.

Source: seed_category_market_size (NielsenIQ-shape), FY25 US National.

4 · Portfolio roles: grow, maintain, fix, prune

Not every brand gets the same mandate or the same money. The plan assigns each brand an explicit role so investment follows strategy rather than history. FY25 revenue is actual; FY29 direction is the planning intent, not a per-brand forecast.

Brand	FY25 rev	Role	Why	FY27–29 mandate
ProteinPeak	$48M	GROW	Wellness Protein +18%; Acme gaining share	Fund the build to ~$140M (target)
RootDay	$62M	GROW	Oat milk +18.8%; small but fast	Protect + extend in a growing space
TrailGrove	$152M	MAINTAIN	Granola +3.3%; healthy, stable	Hold share, self-funding
MorningOats	$87–98M	MAINTAIN	Hot cereal flat; cups +9.8%	Tilt to single-serve growth
Crunchwell	$312M	FIX	Relevance 68.6→62.7; LA –340 bps	Pack Refresh + LA recovery (Report 24)
HoneyNest	$94M	PRUNE	Kids Sweet –2.8%, structural decline	Prune tail SKUs; harvest for cash

Source: seeds/skus.csv (FY25 brand revenue); seed_category_market_size; brand_equity_quarterly.

> **The prune decision, stated plainly**
> HoneyNest sits in Kids Sweet, a segment shrinking –2.8% a year against a rising “mom-guilt” trend (0.68 strength, volume-down). The plan does not reinvest to defend the whole line; it prunes the tail SKUs, keeps the profitable core plus LTO calendar, and redirects the freed shelf and cash toward Wellness Protein. Managed decline is a decision, not a failure.

5 · Capabilities & enablers

The pillars depend on four capabilities the plan explicitly funds. **Innovation throughput:** a stage-gated pipeline that keeps ProteinPeak launching on a rolling cadence (Cinnamon Crunch and Cocoa Almond live; Chocolate Almond concept clears its 55% action standard at 64% top-two-box). **Revenue growth management:** the pricing, trade and mix engine that underwrites the margin commitment. **Commercial / retail-media analytics:** the incrementality discipline that stops us over-paying for cannibalised Amazon volume. **Supply resilience:** after Hurricane Tonya cut fill to ~52% in the affected DCs, the plan hardens the Gulf supply chain so a single weather event cannot cost a region its share again.

- **Innovation:** protect the ProteinPeak launch cadence; hold the Crunchwell Pack Refresh to its 2026-08-15 date; keep the concept funnel above the 55% action standard.
- **RGM:** stand up the five-lever operating rhythm in Report 17 as a permanent capability, not a one-time project.
- **Analytics:** make modelled incrementality — not platform-reported ROAS — the currency for trade and media allocation.
- **Supply:** Gulf-region resilience and DC redundancy so fill holds ~95% through the storm season.

6 · Risks to the plan

Three risks are large enough to move the trajectory. The plan funds against each rather than assuming them away.

Risk	Signal	What it does to the plan	Mitigation in-plan
GLP-1 appetite shift	0.81, volume-down	Category-wide breakfast volume erosion as appetite-suppressant use grows	Skew mix to protein & satiety positioning; value-per-serving over volume
Private label	High-ACV PL launches	Great Value Honey Almond / Nut at 84–86% ACV pressures the value core	RGM price-pack architecture; defend with entry price-points, not deeper trade
Larksfield escalation	Two-front	Field & Honey 14g-protein line ext (May 2026) hits protein + Louisiana at once	ProteinPeak innovation pace; funded LA recovery; endcap-defense media

Source: seed_macro_trends (strength 0–1); seed_competitor_launches; seed_retailers (ACV).

> **The risk that shapes the mix**
> The GLP-1 shift (0.81, volume-down) is the single trend most likely to bend category volume over the plan period. It is also the strategic reason to be over-weight Wellness Protein: as appetite falls, spend concentrates in fewer, higher-value, protein-forward occasions. The mix shift in this plan is partly a hedge against the biggest risk to it.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Adopt the FY27–FY29 revenue and 16%-by-FY28 margin commitment as the Board-level plan of record.	Gregory Whitfield / CFO	This LRP cycle
2	Fund the ProteinPeak build to the ~$140M FY29 target and mass-channel expansion beyond Target.	Sage Park / Corporate Strategy	FY27 planning
3	Execute the Crunchwell fix — Pack Refresh (Aug 15) + funded LA recovery (see Report 24).	Cory Whitman / Marcus Boudreaux	H2 FY26 → FY27
4	Stand up revenue growth management as a permanent capability against the margin commitment (Report 17).	RGM Lead / CFO office	FY27 onward
5	Confirm the HoneyNest prune and redeploy the freed shelf and cash to Wellness Protein.	Priya Raman / Finance	FY27 planning